

Areesha Abrar

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PROFILE

Results-oriented professional with 5+ years in banking, skilled in financial strategy, credit analysis, SQL, Python, and machine learning. Passionate about using data to drive insight and value for purpose-driven organizations

- **Certifications:** Graduate certificate in Applied Machine Learning, Excel, Tableau, SQL, Power BI, Python, Google Analytics 4
- **Analytical Tools and Skills:** Python, Pandas, Spark, SQL, Tableau, Power BI, ETL, Databricks, R Studio, Azure, Bloomberg Terminal, FactSet, Solver, Advanced Excel (pivot tables, macros), Power Query, Financial Modeling, Regression, Hypothesis Testing, Data Visualization, Causal Analytics (A/B Testing), Time Series Analysis

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Dallas, Dallas	MS in Business Analytics & Artificial Intelligence (Data Science) Dean Excellence Scholarship Recipient, Scholar with Distinction	May 2025 GPA 3.9
Institute of Business Management, Karachi	Master of Business Administration Bachelor of Science, Accounting and Finance	Sep 2019 Sep 2016

PROJECTS & HONOURS

Nash Leader – UTD Grad Award	May 2025
• Awarded Nash Leader (top 1%) at UT Dallas for values-driven leadership, strategic thinking, and community impact	
Credit Default Risk Prediction Model – Applied Machine Learning	Mar 2024
• Generated and optimized an XGBoost model to predict credit defaults with 18% fewer false positives; benchmarked against Neural Networks using SHAP analysis	
Robo-Advisory Portfolio Optimizer – JSOM FinHack Finalist (Top 10)	Apr 2025
• Developed a Python-based Robo-Advisory tool using the Markowitz model to generate back-tested portfolios by risk tolerance, improving decision clarity with dynamic risk-return dashboards	
Healthcare Price Transparency Project	May 2025
• Built an end-to-end data pipeline integrating hospital pricing data using Azure Data Factory, Databricks, and Power BI , ensuring accuracy and cost awareness for the public	

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

The University of Texas at Dallas, Dallas, Texas <i>Graduate Student Worker</i>	Aug 2024 – May 2025
Habib Bank Limited, Karachi, Pakistan <i>Team Lead – Structured Credits (International)</i>	Apr 2022 – Jul 2023
• Led risk assessments and portfolio monitoring for \$800M+ global distressed assets, developing dashboards and reports that informed credit decisioning and improved recoveries by 22%	
• Identified \$8.7M+ in high-risk accounts through risk scoring and financial modeling, driving targeted recoveries and enabling a 12% drop in delinquency rates	
• Executed a balance sheet cleanup strategy by analyzing borrower payment behavior, securing \$29M in settlements , and optimizing \$16M+ in write-offs, reducing non-performing assets by 22%	
• Designed risk models and streamlined reporting processes by automating data extraction and analysis using SQL and Excel, improving negotiation timeliness and accuracy for portfolio strategies	
Bank Al Habib Limited, Karachi, Pakistan <i>Lead Analyst – Corporate and Commercial Banking</i>	Nov 2021 – Apr 2022
• Led a \$650M+ lending portfolio , performing portfolio-level transaction monitoring (KYC/AML checks) and variance analysis, identifying irregular cash flows and potential red flags	
• Supported AML and compliance teams in reviewing suspicious activity reports (SARs) and client documentation	
• Flagged misstatements in 5 politically sensitive borrower files, leading to account freeze and potential fine prevention	
Askari Bank Limited, Karachi, Pakistan <i>Financial Analyst – Corporate and Investment Banking</i>	Sep 2018 – Nov 2021
• Delivered 30+ credit memorandum reports via financial modeling and analysis that enabled \$2.3M+ in new loans , surpassing revenue goals by 12%	
• Spearheaded COVID-era restructuring for a top textile client by forecasting cash flows under multiple scenarios, enabling loan renewal and supporting a 12% revenue rebound through cost-optimization and e-commerce pivot	
• Delivered ad hoc financial analyses and reports for senior management for audit and risk approval purposes	